One of the major goals of this chapter is to introduce web3 as an API for accessing blockchain node services. You looked at most of these services in section 7.4.5. So where are the other web3 calls in the MPC-code? They are in the app.js of the MPC-app. In fact, web3 is the means by which the MPC-app web application accesses the MPC-contract and the blockchain services. The core component of MPC-app is app.js, which acts as the bridge between the UI and the blockchain node services, including the smart contract. You already saw in section 7.4.5 how web3 is used for micropayment message formation through a hashing function available in the web3.utils package.

This function is for hashing the micropayment details:

```
web3.utils.soliditySha3(contractAddress,weiamount)
```

Another function specified in the personal package of web3 is for signing a message:

```
web3.personal.sign(message,web3.eth.defaultAccount,function(err,
                                    signedMessage)
```

Access to the smart contract deployed on the blockchain, MPC on Ganache, is provided by

```
web3.eth.Contract(data.abi, contractAddress, ..)
```

Internal computations related to cryptocurrency are in the wei denomination of ether, so when a conversion is required, web3.utils is called:

```
web3.utils.toWei(amount,'ether')
```

A function for accessing the balance of accounts on the chain (in this case, the Ganache test chain) is frequently used in the